

DISABILITY SUPPORT INFORMATION: NORTHWEST TERRITORIES

Before You Send This | Alberta Disability Refugee Series | April 2026

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This page summarizes disability support, housing, health, and travel rules for people considering relocation to this province. Amounts are approximate. Rules change. Always confirm directly with the provincial government before making any decisions.

DISABILITY SUPPORT PROGRAM -- NORTHWEST TERRITORIES

Program Name:	Income Assistance -- Persons with Disabilities Designation
Administered By:	NWT Department of Education, Culture and Employment
Monthly Benefit:	Up to ~\$1,500/month (disability designation + northern allowance)
Benefit Notes:	Disability designation removes employment requirements. A Northern Allowance is added to offset the significantly higher cost of living in the NWT.
Employment Required?	NO -- Disability designation removes all employment expectations under NWT Income Assistance.
CDB Clawback?	NO -- The Northwest Territories does not claw back the federal Canada Disability Benefit.
Re-Diagnosis Required?	Yes -- NWT Income Assistance requires its own disability determination. Your Alberta AISH file is supporting documentation.
Appeal Rights:	Review process available through the Department of Education, Culture and Employment

HOUSING AND COST OF LIVING

Major Cities:	Yellowknife, Hay River, Inuvik, Fort Smith
Average 1BR Rent:	\$1,500-\$2,200/mo (Yellowknife) Varies significantly by community
Rent Note:	The NWT has very high cost of living -- groceries, utilities, and housing cost significantly more than southern Canada. Plan thoroughly.
Rent Control?	Limited rent control in NWT. The Residential Tenancies Act applies. Costs are high regardless.
Subsidized Waitlist:	NWT Housing Corporation has public housing. Yellowknife has availability but competition is high. Waitlists vary by community.
Social Housing:	NWT Housing Corporation; public housing units. Cost of living is very high -- research thoroughly before committing.

HEALTH, MEDICAL, AND TRAVEL RULES

3-Month Health Gap:	Up to 3 months with no NWT Health Care Plan coverage. Register on Day 1.
Health Coverage:	NWT Health Care Plan covers medical. Pharmacy benefits available. Dental and vision for Income Assistance recipients -- confirm coverage levels.
Medical Supplies:	Some coverage available for IA recipients. Confirm your specific needs with the Department before relying on coverage.
Transit/Paratransit:	Yellowknife city transit (limited). No intercity transit. A vehicle is near-essential in almost all NWT communities.
Driver's License:	90 days to exchange your Alberta license in the Northwest Territories.
Vehicle Registration:	Register within 90 days. Road conditions and remote access are important considerations in the NWT.

BEFORE YOU APPLY -- IMPORTANT:

The NWT is remote, isolated, and has extreme climate. Yellowknife is the only significant urban centre. If you are suited to northern life, the supports are genuine. Research thoroughly before committing.

YOUR RIGHTS UNDER THE CANADIAN CHARTER OF RIGHTS AND FREEDOMS

Plain Language Summary | Alberta Disability Refugee Series | April 2026

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The Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms is part of Canada's Constitution. It protects the rights of every person in Canada. Three sections apply directly to disabled Albertans being financially forced out of their province by the ADAP transition.

SECTION 6 -- MOBILITY RIGHTS: YOUR RIGHT TO MOVE

"Every citizen of Canada has the right to move to and take up residence in any province."

- You have a constitutional right to leave Alberta and move to any other province. No law can take that away.
- Other provinces can require a short residency period (usually 3 months) before you access local programs, but they cannot block you from arriving.
- The argument: When the ADAP transition leaves someone without enough money to pay for the move -- transport, first and last month rent, deposits -- it creates a financial barrier that effectively traps people. A right you cannot afford to use is a right being denied.
- Financial destitution caused by government policy can be argued as a violation of Section 6. This is part of why documenting your financial reality matters.

SECTION 7 -- LIFE, LIBERTY AND SECURITY OF THE PERSON

"Everyone has the right to life, liberty and security of the person."

- The Supreme Court of Canada has said Section 7 may protect against government actions that threaten your ability to survive -- including cutting income that covers food, shelter, and medication.
- If moving from AISH to ADAP causes serious physical or psychological harm because the income is no longer sufficient to live on, this may be a Section 7 violation.
- Section 7 also requires that when the government takes something from you, it must follow basic rules of fairness -- including the right to be heard and the right to appeal.
- Removing the independent Citizens Appeal Panel (Bill 12, December 2025) means 79,290 Albertans lost the right to challenge a decision that directly affects their survival. That is a direct challenge to the principles of fundamental justice.

SECTION 15 -- EQUALITY RIGHTS: NO DISCRIMINATION BASED ON DISABILITY

"Every individual is equal before and under the law ... without discrimination based on disability."

- Section 15 is the strongest equality protection for people with disabilities in Canadian law. It applies directly here.
- Creating a two-tier system that sorts disabled people by perceived capacity to work -- and gives those people fewer rights, less money, and no appeal -- may create a disadvantageous distinction based on disability type.
- The people most harmed are those with real, permanent, documented disabilities that do not fit the narrow exemption categories. Section 15 exists precisely to protect them.
- Advocates argue that the ADAP transition treats some disabled people as less worthy of stable support than others -- based entirely on a government assessment of employment potential. That is discrimination.

DAY 1 TO DAY 90 -- WHAT TO DO WHEN YOU ARRIVE

- Day 1: Apply for your new provincial health card. This starts the 3-month clock. Do not wait.
- Day 1: Begin searching for a family doctor. Doctor shortages are real -- start immediately. Ask about walk-in clinics as a bridge.
- Day 30: File your provincial disability application (PWD/ODSP/SAID depending on province). Bring all Alberta documentation.
- Day 60: Exchange your Alberta driver's license (60-90 day deadline in most provinces). After the deadline you are driving illegally.
- Day 90: Register your vehicle in the new province. Safety inspection required in BC and some others.
- Ongoing: Keep copies of everything. Document every interaction with every government office. Dates, names, reference numbers.

ABOUT ME -- PERSONAL IMPACT STATEMENT

Click any box and replace the example text with your own words. No word limits.

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This section is yours. Write as much or as little as you need. You do not have to share anything you are not comfortable sharing. Each box already has example text. Click into it, select all, and replace it with your own words.

MY DISABILITY AND DAILY LIFE

Describe your disability and how it affects your daily life:

MY DISABILITY AND DAILY LIFE

I have been living with [your primary diagnosis -- for example: fibromyalgia, bipolar disorder type I, multiple sclerosis, spinal cord injury]

PHYSICAL IMPACTS:

My condition affects my body in the following ways on a daily basis: [Choose and complete what applies to you] I cannot sit for more than [X] minutes. I cannot walk for more than [X] minutes. I cannot lift more than [X] pounds. I cannot [X].

MY FINANCIAL REALITY

Describe your current financial situation and what the ADAP transition means for you:

I currently receive \$[your AISH amount, e.g. \$1,685 or \$1,940]/month through AISH. My fixed monthly expenses are as follows: [X].

MY HOUSING SITUATION

Describe your current housing and what relocation would mean for you:

I currently live in [city], Alberta. I have been a resident of Alberta for [X] years. I rent / own [choose one] my current home. [X].

MY DEPENDENTS AND SUPPORT NETWORK

Describe any dependents or others who would be affected:

I [have / do not have] dependents who rely on me. [If yes:] I am the primary caregiver for [describe: my child / my children / my spouse / my parent / my sibling / my friend / my neighbor / my community member / my pet / my other dependent].

JULY 1, 2026 -- 82 DAYS FROM DATE OF PUBLICATION

The Province of Alberta is eliminating adequate disability supports for 79,290 Albertans.
I am one of them. I am writing to you because I may have no other option.

STEP 1 -- YOUR AISH INFORMATION

You may leave your name blank to submit anonymously.

Your Full Name (or leave blank to remain anonymous):

Number of years you have been on AISH:

e.g. 10

Your AISH File Number (for government verification):

e.g. 1234567 -- on your AISH correspondence

STEP 2 -- YOUR NOTICE (PRE-WRITTEN -- DO NOT EDIT)

My name is [see above]. I am a Canadian citizen living in Alberta with a permanent disability. I have been receiving Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) for the number of years indicated above. My disability is permanent, documented, and has been assessed by the Government of Alberta as substantially and permanently limiting my ability to earn a livelihood. I am writing to the Government of the Northwest Territories because the Province of Alberta is forcing me out. Please refer to my personal impact statement for full details.

This notice engages Sections 6, 7, and 15 of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms.

STEP 3 -- MY TRANSPORTATION SITUATION (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

- ☐ I have a vehicle and may be able to relocate if I can afford the costs.
- ☐ I do not have a vehicle. There are no affordable interprovincial buses. I do not know how I would get there.
- ☐ I have dependents who would travel with me -- children or a family member who also relies on supports.
- ☐ I have medical equipment, mobility aids, or prescriptions that make relocation complex and costly.

**If ADAP proceeds as planned and I am unable to sustain myself in Alberta,
I will arrive in your province with nothing.**

No savings. No employment history. No local support network. A disability assessed as permanent.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

facebook.com/share/g/1CrU5PfHha/

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AISH CONTACT INFO | SEND TO | STEP 4 -- SIGN AND SUBMIT

Alberta Disability Refugee -- Northwest Territories | July 1, 2026

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AISH / ADAP CONTACT INFORMATION FOR GOVERNMENT VERIFICATION

Recipients of this notice may verify the sender's AISH file status by contacting:

Program:	Alberta Disability Assistance Program (AISH / ADAP transition)
Email:	adapengagement@gov.ab.ca
Phone:	1-877-644-9992 (toll-free)
AISH File #:	[as provided by the sender on page 4 of this document]
Authorization:	The sender consents to release of their file status and eligibility history for the purposes of this interprovincial notice.

WHAT I AM ASKING OF YOUR GOVERNMENT

I am not asking for charity. I am a Canadian citizen asking for the following:

- Acknowledge receipt of this notice and the situation it describes.
- Confirm what disability support programs are available to a new resident of Northwest Territories, and what the transition process would look like.
- Raise the situation of Albertans with disabilities in federal-provincial discussions.
- Consider what coordinated interprovincial response is available to Canadians displaced by provincial policy.
- Send a copy of your response to Premier Danielle Smith of Alberta, so she knows her policy decisions are being tracked.

THIS NOTICE IS BEING SENT TO

- **Premier R.J. Simpson -- Government of Northwest Territories**
premier@gov.nt.ca

- **Minister of Education, Culture and Employment -- Government of Northwest Territories**
minister_ece@gov.nt.ca

- **Premier Danielle Smith -- Government of Alberta**
premier@gov.ab.ca

- **Minister Nathan Neudorf -- Alberta Assisted Living & Social Services**
alss.minister@gov.ab.ca

- **Federal Minister of Disability Inclusion**
hc.ministre-minister.sc@hc-sc.gc.ca

- **HUMA Standing Committee -- House of Commons**
HUMA@parl.gc.ca

- **Alberta Human Rights Commission**
humanrights@gov.ab.ca

STEP 4 -- SIGN AND SUBMIT

Complete all fields, then email this document (including your About Me section) to all recipients above.

Full Name (or 'Submitted Anonymously'):

City / Town, Alberta:

Email Address (optional):

Phone Number (optional):

Date (YYYY-MM-DD):

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